GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

April 03rd, 2026
Week 14
Volume 282, Issue 1229

Highlights:

- **War premium.**
- **Rupee rebound.**
- **Mixed signals.**
- **Bangla leads.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"Patience is not simply the ability to wait, but how we behave while waiting."

-Joyce Meyer

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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Q2 OPENS UNDER PRESSURE!

Week 14 opens the second quarter of 2026 under the same structural pressures that defined Q1, and then some. The Iran war continues to dominate the macro agenda, with Brent crude holding above USD 109/barrel for a seventh consecutive week and the Strait of Hormuz remaining effectively constrained. Geopolitical risk has overtaken supply-demand fundamentals as the primary price driver in energy markets, and ship recycling is feeling the impact from both sides, as higher oil keeps aging vessels trading while a volatile USD makes confident bidding difficult to sustain.

India delivered the week's most notable currency development, as the rupee rebounded sharply from its record low of 94.42 to 92.73 following intervention measures by the Reserve Bank of India, including curbs on forward transactions, limits on banks' FX positions, and restrictions on corporate rebooking of cancelled contracts. Pakistan and Bangladesh saw only marginal currency movement, while the Turkish lira weakened further to a fresh record low of 44.59, continuing a prolonged depreciation trend that is steadily eroding Aliağa's competitiveness for international tonnage.

Even the U.S. Dollar, which has otherwise been a consistent source of pressure on sub-continent markets this year, sent mixed signals again this week, strengthening against the Turkish lira while easing against the Indian rupee. The INR's recovery offers some support to Alang by improving USD-denominated bidding capacity, though the sustainability of this move remains uncertain if oil prices continue to rise and capital outflows resume. These mixed signals continue to cloud price discovery, leaving buyers and sellers struggling to anchor positions and keeping overall market activity subdued, with little progress made on clearing the tonnage backlog that has built up over the course of Q1.

Bangladesh remains the standout positive in the region. The post-Eid momentum seen last week has carried into Week 14, with Chattogram recyclers actively seeking tonnage and maintaining the most engaged sentiment across the sub-continent. India and Pakistan, by contrast, continue to operate cautiously, constrained by limited supply and ongoing uncertainty in steel fundamentals that continues to weigh on bidding confidence.

The broader macro backdrop remains largely unchanged. The Middle East conflict continues to support elevated freight earnings, discouraging owners from recycling older vessels. The Baltic Dry Index has shown only marginal softening, easing to 2,031, while oil remains firmly above USD 100/barrel for a seventh consecutive week. The result is a market where higher energy prices continue to extend vessel trading lives, delaying the flow of tonnage into recycling yards.
As Week 14 settles into Q2, the industry is left asking a familiar question: when will tonnage begin to arrive in sufficient volume to meet the growing appetite from recyclers, particularly in Bangladesh?

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 14 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

Hungry after the holiday

Momentum holds.

The bullishness that characterised Chattogram's return from the Eid break shows no sign of fading as Week 14 opens. Bangladesh's recyclers remain among the most actively engaged in the region, with yard space continuing to clear and appetite for fresh tonnage undiminished. The mood at the waterfront is more constructive than it has been at any point in Q1, and the Letter of Credit pipeline, which has been a persistent drag on transaction velocity, is beginning to move more smoothly as post-holiday central bank approvals gather pace. Bangladesh continues to hold firmer ground in terms of prices offered for recycling candidates than India, maintaining the competitive edge that has defined the sub-continent's pricing hierarchy through the opening quarter.

Compliance tightens.

The two OFAC-sanctioned VLCCs idling at OPL Chattogram remain unresolved and are now entering their third week of limbo. No pathway to a final resting place has emerged, and the heightened due diligence culture they have prompted across the cash buyer community shows no sign of easing. Reports continue to suggest a small number of similarly suspect units remain in cash buyer hands awaiting introduction to the market. Each week that passes without resolution of the Chattogram duo reinforces the caution that buyers and recyclers are now applying to any tonnage with opaque ownership or transaction history. It is a compliance hangover that will outlast the specific vessels that caused it.

Clock ticking.

Bangladeshi steel levels edged fractionally higher to BDT 61,500 this week, a modest but directionally positive move for recyclers whose offers have been anchored by flat local pricing throughout Q1. The USD/BDT rate closed the week at 122.91, barely changed from last week's 122.81, providing minimal FX headwind. The pre-monsoon window is narrowing, the June rains are roughly eight weeks away, and the pressure to convert appetite into executed transactions is beginning to intensify. If the LC pipeline continues to clear and owners begin to release the medium-sized dry bulk and LPG units currently circulating as recycling candidates, Bangladesh has both the will and the financial positioning to absorb them. The clock, however, is ticking.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

STEEL JUMPS, BUT TONNAGE ABSENT

India's most consequential development in Week 14 emerged not from steel prices, but from the foreign exchange market. The Indian Rupee staged a sharp recovery from last week's record low of 94.42, firming to 92.73 against the U.S. Dollar by April 3 following a series of intervention measures by the Reserve Bank of India. These included curbs on forward transactions, tighter limits on banks' foreign exchange positions, and restrictions on corporates rebooking cancelled contracts.

Rupee rebound.

For Alang's recyclers, a stronger INR provides structural support, as vessels are acquired in USD while recycled steel is sold in rupees. This shift marginally improves bidding economics. Local steel plate prices also edged higher to INR 38,500 per ton, lifting the USD equivalent towards USD 415 per ton and offering modest support compared to the previous week.

Energy drag.

This improvement, however, is being offset by emerging pressure on the energy side. LPG supply disruptions are now affecting steel mills in Alang, slowing production and weakening underlying demand for recycled steel. While partial relief has been announced, the extent to which this will translate into improved yard economics remains uncertain. Market indications continue to show that Indian recyclers are offering the lowest price levels in the sub-continent, highlighting how quickly operational constraints can offset gains from currency and steel movements. India's core challenge remains unchanged. Tonnage availability continues to fall short of what is required to sustain meaningful yard activity. Alang has the infrastructure, compliance credentials, and capacity, but without sufficient inflow of vessels, these advantages remain underutilised.

No supply.

Structurally, India retains its strongest edge in HKC compliance. With more than 110 yards holding valid Statements of Compliance, Alang remains the most capable destination in the region for handling regulated European and Japanese tonnage at scale. The Good Friday bank holiday on April 3 provided only a temporary pause and does not alter the broader outlook. Until freight markets soften and geopolitical pressures ease, the flow of recycling candidates is likely to remain constrained. The infrastructure is ready. The supply is not.

HKC strength.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

FIRMER GROUND

Firm footing.

Pakistan enters Week 14 on firmer commercial footing than at any point during Q1. The steel plate jump recorded at the end of March, rising from PKR 168,000 to PKR 175,000 per ton, has held into the new quarter, with pricing consolidating near PKR 175,000 and the USD equivalent settling around USD 627 per ton. The Pakistani Rupee has remained broadly stable at 279.07, reinforcing this improvement and marking a clear shift from the prolonged weakness that weighed on Gadani's economics through much of March. Market indications now place Pakistan ahead of India in pricing terms, reestablishing Gadani as the sub-continent's second most competitive recycling destination.

Back in play.

Structural improvements are also becoming more visible. Three HKC-certified yards are now operational, with further certifications expected in the coming weeks. Combined with proximity to Gulf-sourced tonnage influenced by ongoing regional tensions, Gadani is increasingly positioning itself as a practical alternative when Alang faces limited inflow. The current pool of recycling candidates, including medium-sized dry bulk, LPG, and offshore units, aligns well with Gadani's available yard capacity and improving compliance profile.

Supply decides.

At current levels, the gap between indicative sentiment and executable pricing appears narrower than it has been in recent months. With steel holding firm and the PKR stable, recyclers are operating on a more predictable cost base than earlier in the year. The key variable now is supply. Whether owners choose to release tonnage at prevailing levels, and whether regional dynamics continue to direct units toward Pakistan, will determine how sustainable this improvement proves to be. The market is clearly stronger than it was. Whether it can build on that momentum remains the open question.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

STILL ALONE AT THE BOTTOM TABLE

Lira slides.

Turkey enters Q2 with the Turkish Lira weakening further to a record low of 44.59 against the U.S. Dollar, extending a depreciation trend that has now run for most of the past year and reflects a decline of over 17% during that period. The Central Bank of Turkey has intervened heavily, reportedly selling more than USD 8 billion in reserves during March, while also halting its rate-cutting cycle in response to inflationary pressures driven by rising energy costs. These measures, however, have provided little relief to Aliaga's recyclers. The continued weakening of the lira directly compresses the USD value of local steel prices, widening the gap between Turkish offers and sub-continent levels.

Outpriced again.

At current indications of USD 265-285 per LDT depending on vessel type, down from last week's USD 270-290 range, Aliaga remains uncompetitive for mainstream recycling tonnage. The domestic steel scrap market continues to reflect weak demand from the construction sector, while inflation, running at 31.53% as of February, keeps operating conditions challenging. Broader geopolitical uncertainty and elevated energy prices continue to weigh on the domestic economy, and activity levels reflect this pressure, with no significant sales or major new enquiries reported during the week.

Niche only.

Turkey's relevance continues to rest in its specialist segment. EU-approved yards remain capable of receiving EU-flagged vessels under the Ship Recycling Regulation, providing a limited but consistent flow of compliant tonnage. This segment operates independently of sub-continent pricing dynamics, as European owners prioritise regulatory compliance over commercial returns. Outside of this niche, however, Turkey remains structurally constrained. The question of when Aliaga can re-enter the market as a competitive destination for mainstream recycling tonnage remains unresolved, and nothing in Week 14 suggests that shift is imminent.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 14 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Improving**	455 / LDT	475 / LDT	485 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	445 / LDT	465 / LDT	475 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	430 / LDT	450 / LDT	460 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	265 / LDT	275 / LDT	285 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *The 72.55 million MT of CO_2 emissions avoided through ship recycling activities at Alang is equivalent to the annual emissions of approximately 13.2 million Indian households.*

- *Steel recovered from ships recycled at Alang uses 60-70% less energy compared to conventional iron ore-based production.*

- *The 69.16 million tons of steel recovered from ships recycled at Alang are enough to construct well over 1,500 Burj Khalifa towers.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
May 01 – Buddha Purnima	April 01 – April 06 April 16 – April 23

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
April 14 – Bengali New Year	April 17 – April 20 April 30

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
May 01 – Labour Day	April 23 - National Sovereignty and Children's Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of April 03, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Celerix	9,343	Oil Tanker	*Delivered April 01*
2	Kuljak Arrow	10,241	Bulk Carrier	*Delivered April 01*
3	Bikra	4,333	Oil Tanker	Arrived April 01
4	D/V Diu Towed by Tug Pacific Dove	27,538	MODU	Arrived April 02
Morality		***51,455***		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of April 03, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Tai Ji	3,241	Refrigerate Cargo Ship	Arrived March 31
2	*Shuen*	*1,589*	Container	Arrived March 31

GADANI - Port Position as of April 03, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
	No new vessels reported.			
Total Tonnage		**-**		

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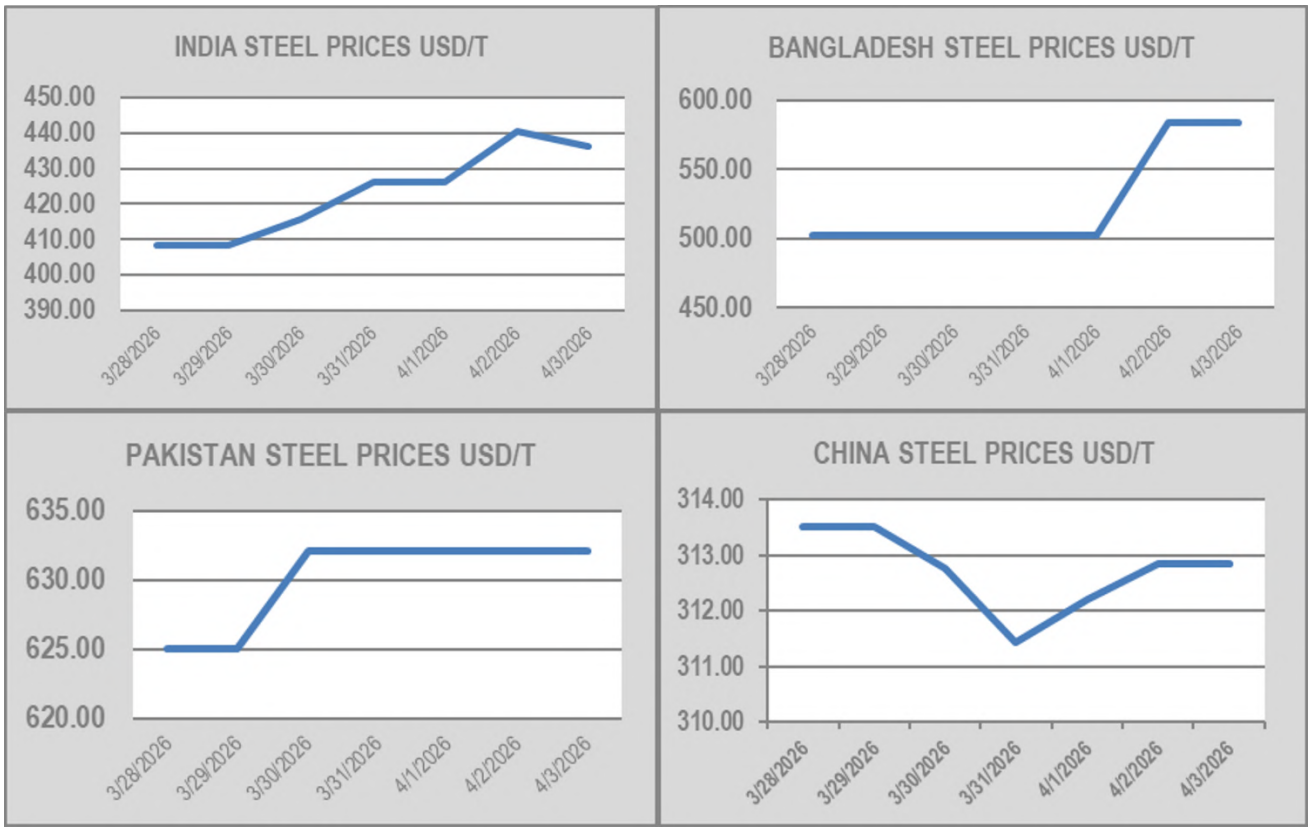
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
3/28/2026	408.18	38,700.00	625.00	175,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	313.51
3/29/2026	408.18	38,700.00	625.00	175,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	313.51
3/30/2026	415.74	39,400.00	632.14	177,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	312.76
3/31/2026	426.30	40,400.00	632.14	177,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	311.44
4/1/2026	426.30	40,400.00	632.14	177,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	312.21
4/2/2026	440.39	41,000.00	632.14	177,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	312.86
4/3/2026	436.09	40,600.00	632.14	177,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	312.86



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